ZikShare

ACADEMIC VAULT

UNIZIK FRESHER EDITION | 2026

Exam Preparation and Revision: A Four-Week Plan That Holds Up

Plan, practise and manage exam-day pressure without last-minute panic

STUDY SKILLS

Study Skills

General Studies (GST / CED)
GST Directorate | 100L

Written for students, by students.

Practical notes, worked examples, practice questions and a revision plan.

Free to download. No fee, no payment step, no watermark.

Independent study support | Not an official UNIZIK publication

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Why this pack exists

This pack gives you a four-week revision architecture, a way to prioritise courses by risk and weight, and exam-hall technique for multiple-choice, theory and calculation papers. It also covers the practical side: materials, timing and the night before.

This is a student-written study companion, not a reproduced lecture handout or a leaked examination paper. Use it to organise the topics you are taught, practise the kind of thinking your course rewards, and walk into class with better questions.

What you will be able to do

- Build a four-week revision plan prioritised by course risk.
- Use spaced testing instead of rereading slides.
- Apply paper-specific exam technique for objective, theory and calculation questions.
- Manage exam anxiety and the 24 hours before a paper.

How to use this pack

1. Skim the whole pack once in 20 minutes so you know what is inside.
2. Work through one section at a time with your lecture note and recommended text beside you.
3. Attempt the practice questions before reading the answers. Mark what you missed.
4. Use the final checklist to plan your revision week, one tick per study session.

> **Free to download, always**
> This pack is free. There is no fee, no subscription and no payment step before download, and the full PDF is not watermarked or locked. Share the link with a coursemate instead of forwarding the file.

> **Confirm your official course outline**
> Course codes, credit units and outlines can differ by department and session. Treat this pack as supplementary support and confirm the current outline with your lecturer, course rep or departmental handbook before an assessment.

Prioritise before you plan

Not every course deserves equal time. Rank them by consequence and current weakness.

- List every course with its credit unit and exam date.
- Rate your current confidence from one to five with evidence, not feeling.
- Compute a simple priority score: credit units times the gap between confidence and five.
- Give the highest scores more blocks, but never abandon a course entirely.
- Protect the courses with early exam dates from being crowded out.
- Put the plan on paper where you can see it daily.

The four-week architecture

Spread the work so the final week is consolidation, not first-time learning.

1. Week four before: skim all syllabi, gather materials, write topic checklists.
2. Week three: cover the weakest high-priority topics, one past question per course.
3. Week two: active recall across all courses, timed sections, fix repeated errors.
4. Week one: full past papers under exam conditions, then targeted repair only.
5. Each day: two or three courses maximum, alternating heavy and lighter subjects.
6. Last 48 hours: review summaries, formula sheets and error logs. No new topics.

> **Test, do not reread**
> Rereading creates familiarity. Closing the book and writing from memory creates the retrieval skill the exam actually requires.

In the hall

Exam technique is worth marks independent of knowledge.

- Read all instructions and check the number of questions and sections.
- Budget time per question and keep a few minutes for review.
- Answer the easiest questions first to secure marks and settle nerves.
- For objective questions, answer every item unless there is a penalty for guessing.
- For theory, define terms, structure with paragraphs and use examples.
- For calculations, show method, units and a final statement. Box your answer.

> **If you blank**
> Write the question in your own words, list what you know about the topic and start with the definition. Motion usually returns recall.

Revision is retrieval under exam conditions

Most students revise by reading notes and highlighting, which produces a feeling of familiarity that collapses in the exam hall. The exam does not ask you to recognise your notes; it asks you to produce an answer from memory within a time limit. So revision must practise that exact activity.

Past questions are the best available evidence of what the examiner values. Work them closed-book, under time, then mark your own answer against the course outline and the marks available. The gap between what you wrote and what was required is your revision list.

Distribute practice across the weeks before the exam. Five sessions of one hour across five days beats one five-hour session, because each session begins with forgetting that must be overcome - and that effort is what consolidates memory.